PART 5

Policy statements and sign-off

Each statement is signed in NicoNet under Company, Policies & sign-off, where the signature is recorded with the date, time and version. This printed copy is for the staff file.

Nicholson Group Culture Code Everyone

v1 · 3 Nov 2026

1. I have read the Nicholson Group Culture Code in the Company section of NicoNet: pride in everything we do; respect the process; solutions, not excuses; one team, one standard; excellence is our default; positivity and professionalism; accountability and trust; growth mindset; no drama, no blame, no toxicity; and the Nicholson Way.
2. I understand that every member of the team is responsible for upholding the culture, and I commit to living it in how I work, how I treat colleagues, residents, contractors and suppliers, and how I represent the Nicholson name on site, in residents' homes, online and in public.
3. I understand that the Culture Code sets out the standards and behaviour the Company expects of everyone. It is Company policy and is not contractual. It sits alongside the Staff Handbook, the other statements in Policies & sign-off and, for subcontractors, the terms of engagement.
4. Where the Company has a concern about conduct, performance or attitude, it will deal with it fairly and consistently under the capability, disciplinary and grievance procedures in the Staff Handbook or, for subcontractors, under the terms of engagement. Nothing in the Culture Code stops anyone raising a concern, a grievance or a protected disclosure, and nobody will suffer any detriment for doing so.

Name	Signature	Date

Receipt of personal protective equipment (PPE) Everyone

v1 · Nov 2026

1. I confirm that I have received the PPE issued to me by the Company, as recorded on my PPE issue record in NicoNet, free of charge. The Company provides PPE under the Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations 1992 (as amended in 2022) and the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974.
2. I have been shown how to wear, adjust, use, store and check this PPE, and I understand its limits. I will wear it whenever the job, the risk assessment, the method statement, site rules or my manager requires it. PPE is the last line of defence. It does not replace safe working methods.
3. I will look after my PPE, keep it clean and stored properly, and check it before each use. I will report any loss, damage or defect to Kevin Sharp straight away through Uniform & PPE, and will not use defective PPE. I will not alter PPE or use it for anything other than its intended purpose.
4. PPE and uniform remain Company property. I will return them when asked, on replacement and when I leave. I understand that refusing or failing to wear required PPE is a breach of health and safety rules and may lead to my removal from site and disciplinary action, or termination of a contractor engagement.

Name	Signature	Date

Standard of work Everyone

v1 · Nov 2026

1. Every job is finished to a snag-free, handover-ready standard: right first time, built to the specification, the job sheet and good trade practice, and to current Building Regulations and British Standards where they apply. Work that does not meet that standard is not complete.
2. Before I close a job I will check my own work, clean and make good the area, remove all waste and tools, and upload clear before and after photographs to My jobs. I will record accurately what I did, the materials I used and any further work needed. I will never mark a job complete that is not.
3. In a tenant's home I will show my ID, be polite and respectful, protect floors and furnishings, keep noise and disruption to a minimum, and leave the property secure. I will not discuss Company business, other tenants or rents with tenants. Keys and access codes are kept secure and returned the same day.
4. Defective or incomplete work, including work a tenant rejects, will be returned to me to put right at no extra cost to the Company and within my normal working hours. Repeated failure to meet the standard of work will be dealt with under the Company's capability and disciplinary procedures, or, for contractors, may end the engagement.

Name	Signature	Date

Health and safety, risk assessments and method statements

Everyone

v2 · 3 Nov 2026

1. I have read and understood the Company's health and safety policy (Part F of the Staff Handbook) and the risk assessments and method statements (RAMS) for the work I carry out. I will follow them, attend inductions and toolbox talks, and sign RAMS before starting work on any site.
2. I will only use tools, plant and access equipment that I am trained, competent and authorised to use, and will check them before use. I will not work at height, on live electrics, on gas, with asbestos-containing materials or in confined spaces unless I am qualified and authorised and the correct controls are in place. If I find suspected asbestos I will stop work and report it immediately.
3. I will report every accident, near miss, dangerous occurrence and unsafe condition to my manager the same day, so that it can be recorded and, where required, reported under RIDDOR. I will not work under the influence of alcohol or drugs, and will tell my manager if any prescribed medication may affect my ability to work safely.
4. I have the right to stop work that I believe is unsafe and to report it without suffering any detriment.

Name	Signature	Date

Harassment, sexual harassment and third-party harassment

Everyone

v1 · 3 Nov 2026

1. I have read Part B8 of the Staff Handbook (or, as a subcontractor, Part C) and the harassment risk assessment summary. I understand what harassment, sexual harassment, bullying and victimisation are, and that they are not tolerated at Nicholson, whoever is responsible.
2. I will treat colleagues, residents, subcontractors, suppliers and members of the public with dignity and respect. I will not make unwanted comments, jokes, gestures, messages or contact, of a sexual nature or related to anyone's age, disability, gender reassignment, race, religion or belief, sex or sexual orientation, at work, on site, in a resident's home, in a company vehicle, at work events or online.
3. If I am harassed, or I see or hear about harassment of anyone working for Nicholson, including by a resident or other third party, I will report it in NicoNet to Kevin Sharp or Paul Nicholson. If I feel unsafe in a resident's home or on a site I will leave straight away and report it. I understand that I will not suffer any detriment for reporting in good faith.
4. I have completed, or will complete before my first job in a resident's home, the harassment awareness training, and I will complete the refresher every year. I understand that harassment by me is gross misconduct, or for a subcontractor will end the engagement.

Name	Signature	Date

Code of conduct and instructions Employees

v1 · Nov 2026

1. I may be deployed to any team or task at the direction of management. My team allocation does not limit my duties.
2. Instructions and commands come only from Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp, unless Paul Nicholson authorises otherwise. HR enforcement and debt collection by Callum Hesketh are authorised by Paul Nicholson.
3. The working day is 8:00am to 4:00pm, Monday to Friday. I will clock in on site by 7:50am at the latest, and clock out at the end of the day, through NicoNet. The Company does not pay overtime. Sickness is reported in NicoNet under Sickness by 7:30am on the day; lateness is messaged to Kevin Sharp in NicoNet before 7:50am. Texts and WhatsApp messages are not used for work.
4. I will treat colleagues, tenants, contractors and the public with courtesy and respect. Bullying, harassment, discrimination, theft, dishonesty and the misuse of Company property, vehicles or materials are gross misconduct.

Name	Signature	Date

Subcontractor Code and site rules Subcontractors

v1 · Nov 2026

1. I work for Nicholson Construction Limited as an independent business under the Self Employed Subcontractor Framework Agreement, and I have read Part E of the handbook (the Subcontractor Code).
2. I am free to accept or decline each Work Order. Once I accept one, I will carry out the work to the specification, the RAMS and the site rules, and message Kevin Sharp in NicoNet as early as possible if I cannot attend.
3. I will sign in and out of each site through NicoNet as the site safety and fire register, and follow Part C of the handbook as the site rules for working on Nicholson sites and in residents' homes.
4. Only Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp may issue or vary a Work Order. I will keep my insurance, CIS registration, trade cards and tickets current and up to date in NicoNet.

Name	Signature	Date

Drugs and alcohol testing addendum

Employees

v2 · Nov 2026 (replaces 13 Apr 2025)

1. This addendum forms part of my contract of employment with Nicholson Employment Services Limited and replaces the addendum dated 13 April 2025. It gives effect to Part B10 of the Staff Handbook.
2. I agree not to work, drive for work or attend a site or a resident's home under the influence of alcohol or drugs, and to tell Paul Nicholson in confidence about any medicine that could affect my safety at work.
3. Because my role involves site work, tools, heights, electricity or driving, I agree that I may be asked to take an alcohol breath test or a drug test at random and without notice, where there is reasonable cause, and after an accident or serious near miss. If I work only in the office, I may be tested only for cause or after an incident.
4. I understand that tests are carried out in private by a trained person or an external provider, that a non-negative result is confirmed by a laboratory, that I may ask for the split sample to be tested independently, and that results are seen only by Paul Nicholson and kept for 12 months or as long as any disciplinary process requires.
5. I understand that if I refuse a test without good reason, tamper with a sample or have a confirmed positive result, I will be removed from site and taken home, and the matter will be dealt with under the disciplinary procedure, which may lead to dismissal for gross misconduct. If I ask for help with a drug or alcohol problem before a test is requested, it will be treated as a health matter.

Name	Signature	Date

Confidentiality, data protection and use of NicoNet Everyone

v1 · Nov 2026

1. I will keep confidential all information about the Company, its tenants, properties, finances, suppliers and staff, both during and after my employment or engagement. I will not take, copy, photograph or share tenant personal data, keys, access codes or Company documents except as my job requires.
2. Photographs I take on Company work belong to the Company and are uploaded only to NicoNet. I will not post Company work, properties, tenants or colleagues on social media without written permission from Paul Nicholson.
3. My NicoNet login is personal to me. I will not share it or let anyone else clock in or out for me. I understand that clocking in and out records my location at that moment, solely to confirm I am at an authorised workplace, as explained in the Location & privacy notice. The Company processes my personal data in line with UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018 (ICO registration ZC289932).
4. I will report any lost device, lost key or suspected data breach to Paul Nicholson immediately.

Name	Signature	Date

Messages, the office and residents Everyone

v1 · 6 Nov 2026

1. Everything between me and the Company goes through NicoNet. My messages go to the office team (Paul Nicholson, Kevin Sharp and Callum Hesketh), who answer them in NicoMGT by the end of the working day. I understand that Claude drafts each reply and a member of the office team checks it before it is sent, and that formal grievances and confidential concerns go only to Paul Nicholson.
2. When a resident messages me about a repair allocated to me, I will reply from NicoNet the same working day. I understand that a message I have not answered by the end of the working day is escalated to Kevin Sharp.
3. I will use first names only. I will never give a resident my phone number, email address or social media, ask for theirs, or move the conversation to texts, WhatsApp or calls.
4. I understand that Claude checks every reply I send to a resident before it goes, and that a reply about rent, arrears, deposits, notice, compensation, cost or blame, another resident or contact details is held and passed to the office. I will keep to my job, and pass complaints and any change to the job to the office the same day. I will not agree extra work, promise a date I cannot keep or take payment.
5. I will be polite, short and factual, I will not argue with a resident, and I will not reply to abuse: I will flag it to Kevin Sharp. I understand that every message is kept on the job record and may be read by the resident, the office, the council, the ombudsman and the courts.

Name	Signature	Date

Company property, tools and materials Everyone

v1 · Nov 2026

1. Tools, equipment, materials, keys, uniform, PPE and devices supplied by the Company remain its property. They are for Company work only and must be kept secure, maintained and returned on request or when I leave.
2. Materials are ordered only through a valid order approved by Paul Nicholson. Surplus materials are returned to stores and are not taken home or used for private work.
3. I may be asked to pay for, or have deducted from my pay (to the extent the law and my written contract allow), the cost of Company property lost or damaged through my negligence or deliberate act, or not returned when I leave.

Name	Signature	Date